



PREPOSITIONS OF TIME: FOR, DURING, WHILE



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:
1FVX-61L2-594



1

Warm up

Look at the sentences below and say if the given statements are true (T) or false (F).

1. They took a break during the meeting.
2. He read a book while waiting for the bus.
3. We travelled for the entire summer.

1. "During" is used to indicate a specific period of time within which something happens. _____
2. "While" is used to indicate an action that occurs at the same time as another action. _____
3. "For" is used to indicate an action that occurs at the same time as another action. _____





2

Language point: for, during, while (theory)

We often use 'for', 'during' and 'while' when we talk about periods of time. Study the boxes below.

Use and examples of 'for'

- We use **for** + a period of time

for 10 minutes for ages for a long time for 10 years for 6 months

- We can use **for** with all tenses:

I haven't seen you for ages! I waited for three hours. I'll remember it for a life.

Use and examples of 'during'

- We use **during** + noun to say when something happens, not how long it happens:

I fell asleep during the meeting.

during the week during the match during summer

- With a time word such as *the week, the summer, the afternoon, the night*, we can also use **in**:

Jack works hard during the week. Jack works hard in the week.



**Use and examples of 'while'**

- We also use while + subject + verb to say when something happens:

*The phone rang **while** I was having breakfast.*

*Her husband arrived **while** she was in the bathroom.*

*Did you visit the Colosseum **while** you were in Rome?*

- We use the present tense after **while** when we talk about the future:

*I'm going to visit Sydney next month. I'll call you **while** I'm there.*

(NOT: ... while I will be there.)

*Please take lots of pictures **while** you **are** on holiday.*

(NOT: ... while you will be on holiday.)

3 Language point: for, during, while (practice)

Part A: Complete the sentences with 'for' or 'during'.

Group 1:

1. I stayed at the Bridge Hotel _____ three days.
2. Are you going anywhere interesting _____ the holiday period?
3. We had a fantastic time _____ our trip to Venice.
4. It's been raining _____ almost a week!
5. I hardly ever go out _____ the week. I'm just too busy.
6. Tom has changed his job three times _____ the year.



**Group 2:**

1. After the argument, the couple stopped talking to each other _____ two weeks.
2. The documentary went on _____ nearly three hours.
3. I almost fell asleep _____ the documentary.
4. Jane has insomnia. She can't sleep _____ the night.
5. Where have you been? I've been waiting here _____ over an hour.
6. I'll find some time to answer my emails _____ the weekend.

Part B: Complete the sentences with 'during' or 'while'.**Group 1:**

1. Don't wake the baby _____ she is sleeping.
2. Paolo kept texting his friends _____ the lesson.
3. I didn't meet anyone interesting _____ the party, so I went home early.
4. I didn't meet anyone interesting _____ I was at the party, so I went home early.
5. Be careful _____ you drive home.
6. _____ dinner, Sarah suddenly felt sick.

Group 2:

1. He interrupted me _____ I was speaking.
2. You have to turn down the heat _____ the sauce is cooking.
3. I didn't have time to finish all my tasks, so I had to work _____ the weekend.
4. Did anyone visit you _____ you were at home?
5. A lot of guests arrived _____ the evening.
6. They got to know each other really well _____ they were working in the same office.



4

Listening comprehension

Part A: Listen to the two dialogues about people who are talking about their holidays. Choose the correct answer.

**Dialogue 1:**

1. How long did Sam's family stay in the mountains?
 - a. one day
 - b. two days
 - c. three days
 - d. four days
2. What did Sam's family do in the evenings?
 - a. played board games
 - b. watched movies
 - c. had bonfires and roasted marshmallows
 - d. went stargazing
3. What did Sam and his dad do at the nearby lake?
 - a. They went boating.
 - b. They caught fish.
 - c. They swam.
 - d. They collected rocks.
4. What happened on the second day of the camping trip?
 - a. It snowed.
 - b. It was sunny all day.
 - c. It rained.
 - d. They went to a theme park.
5. What advice does Sam give to Alex about camping?
 - a. Bring lots of books.
 - b. Pack enough food and water.
 - c. Bring a telescope.
 - d. Always camp near a city.

**Dialogue 2:**

1. What were Jenna's favourite places to visit in Rome?
 - a. the Trevi Fountain and the Spanish Steps
 - b. the Colosseum and the Vatican
 - c. the Pantheon and Piazza Navona
 - d. the Roman Forum and Palatine Hill
2. What activity did Jenna enjoy in Venice?
 - a. visiting museums
 - b. shopping for souvenirs
 - c. going on a gondola ride
 - d. attending a concert
3. What did Jenna eat almost every day during her trip?
 - a. salad and soup
 - b. seafood and rice
 - c. pasta and pizza
 - d. sandwiches and fries
4. Who did Jenna meet during her train ride from Rome to Florence?
 - a. local tour guide
 - b. couple from Australia
 - c. group of students
 - d. family from Germany
5. What was the only challenge Jenna faced during her trip?
 - a. finding accommodation
 - b. transportation issues
 - c. language barrier
 - d. weather conditions





Part B: Look at the sentences below and fill in the gaps with the correct preposition of time 'for', 'during' or 'while'.

Dialogue 1

1. Sam's family stayed in the mountains _____ three days.
2. They went hiking _____ the day.
3. They had bonfires and roasted marshmallows _____ the evenings.
4. It rained _____ the second day.
5. They played board games _____ it was raining.

Dialogue 2

1. Jenna visited Italy _____ two weeks.
2. She explored historical sites _____ her stay in Rome.
3. Jenna took lots of pictures _____ she was in Italy.
4. She went on a gondola ride _____ she was in Venice.
5. Jenna met a friendly couple from Australia _____ her train ride from Rome to Florence.

5

Speaking practice

Work in pairs. Each pair will choose or be assigned one of the following scenarios. You will then create a creative and detailed story based on that scenario. Together, brainstorm and develop your story. Ensure to use the prepositions of time "for," "during," and "while" frequently and appropriately. Take turns presenting your story to the class. Make sure each partner contributes to the storytelling.

Example scenario

Imagine you found a mysterious map that led you to a hidden world. Describe your journey, what you did in this world, and how long you stayed.

Example answer: "For three days, we travelled through enchanted forests. During our adventure, we met talking animals and discovered magical treasures. While exploring a hidden cave, we found a powerful artefact that granted wishes."

**Scenario 1: time travel expedition**

You and your partner invent a time machine and decide to visit different historical periods. Describe the periods you visit, what you do there, and any interesting encounters.

Scenario 2: future city exploration

Imagine you wake up one hundred years in the future. Describe the futuristic city, the technology you see, and the activities you engage in.

Scenario 3: underwater kingdom

You discover an underwater kingdom filled with mermaids and sea creatures. Describe your interactions, what you learn about their culture, and how long you stay.

6**Talking point**

In pairs, discuss the following questions.

1. Talk about a recent holiday you went on. How long did you stay? What activities did you do? What did you do at specific times?
2. Describe a typical weekend. What do you usually do? How long do you spend on different activities? What do you do simultaneously?
3. How long do you usually spend on your hobbies each week?
4. What do you typically do during your holidays?
5. What activities do you enjoy doing while listening to music?
6. How do you stay productive during a busy day?
7. How do you relax for a few hours after a long week?



Transcripts

4. Listening comprehension

Narrator: One

Alex: Hey, Sam! What did you do over the weekend?

Sam: Hi, Alex! I went camping with my family. We stayed in the mountains for three days. It was so refreshing to get away from the city.

Alex: That sounds amazing! Did you do any special activities while you were there?

Sam: Yes, we did a lot of things. We went hiking during the day, and in the evenings, we had bonfires and roasted marshmallows. It was a lot of fun.

Alex: Hiking sounds great. Did you see any wildlife during your hikes?

Sam: We saw a few deer and lots of birds. It was really cool to see animals in their natural habitat. My younger brother was thrilled.

Alex: That must have been exciting for him. What else did you do while you were camping?

Sam: We also went fishing in a nearby lake. My dad and I caught a few fish, and we cooked them for dinner. Fresh fish tastes so much better!

Alex: I bet it does. Did you have any challenges during your camping trip?

Sam: Well, it rained for a bit on the second day, which made things a little difficult. But we stayed in our tents during the rain and played board games. It was actually quite fun.

Alex: Sounds like you made the best of it. I'd love to go camping sometime. Do you have any tips for a beginner like me?

Sam: Sure! Make sure to pack enough food and water, and always be prepared for changes in the weather. Also, don't forget a first-aid kit. Safety is important.

Alex: Thanks for the tips, Sam. Maybe I'll plan a camping trip soon.

Narrator: Two

Emily: Hi, Jenna! How was your vacation in Italy?

Jenna: Hi, Emily! It was amazing! I visited Italy for two weeks and had the best time exploring different cities.

Emily: That sounds incredible! What did you enjoy the most during your trip?

Jenna: I think my favourite part was exploring the historical sites. During my stay in Rome, I visited the Colosseum and the Vatican. The history and architecture were just breathtaking.



- Emily:** I can imagine! Did you take lots of photos while you were there?
- Jenna:** Yes, I took hundreds of pictures. Every corner of Rome has something beautiful or interesting to photograph. I'll definitely show you some later.
- Emily:** I'd love that! Did you have any interesting experiences during your trip?
- Jenna:** Oh, absolutely! While I was in Venice, I went on a gondola ride. It was so romantic and peaceful, gliding through the canals and seeing the city from the water.
- Emily:** That sounds wonderful! Did you try any local foods?
- Jenna:** Yes, I did. Italian food is so delicious! I had pasta and pizza almost every day. During my time in Florence, I tried the famous Florentine steak. It was so good!
- Emily:** I'm getting hungry just thinking about it. Did you meet any interesting people while travelling?
- Jenna:** Yes, I met some wonderful people. During my train ride from Rome to Florence, I met a friendly couple from Australia. We ended up sightseeing together for a day and had a lot of fun.
- Emily:** It's always nice to meet new people while travelling. Did you have any challenges during your trip?
- Jenna:** The only challenge was the language barrier at times, but most people were very patient and helpful. Plus, I learned a few Italian phrases that really helped.
- Emily:** That's great! It sounds like you had a fantastic time. I hope I can visit Italy someday too.
- Jenna:** You definitely should, Emily. It's an experience you'll never forget.



Key

1. Warm up

5 mins.

This task should help students practice using prepositions of time in different contexts.

1. T
2. T
3. F - it is used to indicate the duration of an activity.

2. Language point: for, during, while (theory)

5 mins.

Go through the boxes with the explanations.

3. Language point: for, during, while (practice)

Part A:

5 mins.

Students complete the gaps with the preposition 'for' or 'during'. Ask them to refer to the boxes with information if any doubts occur.

Group 1:

- | | | | | | |
|--------|-----------|-----------|--------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. for | 2. during | 3. during | 4. for | 5. during | 6. during |
|--------|-----------|-----------|--------|-----------|-----------|

Group 2:

- | | | | | | |
|--------|--------|-----------|-----------|--------|-----------|
| 1. for | 2. for | 3. during | 4. during | 5. for | 6. during |
|--------|--------|-----------|-----------|--------|-----------|

Part B:

5 mins.

Students complete the gaps with the preposition 'while' or 'during'. Monitor and assist if needed.

Group 1:

- | | | | | | |
|----------|-----------|-----------|----------|----------|-----------|
| 1. while | 2. during | 3. during | 4. while | 5. while | 6. During |
|----------|-----------|-----------|----------|----------|-----------|

Group 2:

- | | | | | | |
|----------|----------|-----------|----------|-----------|----------|
| 1. while | 2. while | 3. during | 4. while | 5. during | 6. while |
|----------|----------|-----------|----------|-----------|----------|

4. Listening comprehension

Part A:

5 mins.

Students listen to two passages and choose the most suitable answer. Play the recordings twice.

Dialogue 1:

- | | | | | |
|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| 1. c. | 2. c. | 3. b. | 4. c. | 5. b. |
|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|

**Dialogue 2:**

1. b. 2. c. 3. c. 4. b. 5. c.

Part B:

5 mins.

Students read the sentences and try to complete the gaps with the correct preposition of time. Monitor and assist if needed.

Dialogue 1

1. for 2. during 3. during 4. during 5. while

Dialogue 2

1. for 2. during 3. while 4. while 5. during

5. Speaking practice

15 mins.

This task encourages students to use their imagination while practising prepositions of time, enhancing both their creativity and their grasp of these grammatical elements.

6. Talking point

5 mins.

Ask students to share a personal experience using prepositions of time.